

Submission Worksheet

Submission Data

Course: IT265-002-S2026

Assignment: IT265 Case Study - Personal Choice

Student: Kevin D. (knd)

Status: Submitted | **Worksheet Progress:** 100%

Potential Grade: 10.00/10.00 (100.00%)

Received Grade: 0.00/10.00 (0.00%)

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Grading Link: <https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-case-study-personal-choice/grading/knd>

View Link: <https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-case-study-personal-choice/view/knd>

Instructions

Step 1: Pick a game you plan to analyze

Step 2: Playtest your game choice (or review streamers playing the game)

Step 3: Analyze, research, and review your chosen game. Collect resources (website links, etc that you used during the exploration) include these with the responses in the related sections. Fill in the responses of the below prompts/checklist/etc.

Step 4: Export the PDF. Upload it to Github and upload the same PDF to Canvas.

Section #1: (1.25 pts.) Game Overview

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Historical Context and Game Description

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Game's title, developer, publisher, platform, and release date.
- Historical context of the game's release and its place in the industry.
- Game's genre and how it compares to similar games of the time.

Your Response:

Persona 3 Reload was published by Atlus and developed by P Studio in 2024 and is a remake of the 2006 game Persona 3, it was released on Switch 2, Xbox One, Playstation 5, and PC. It is a rpg that combines core combat mechanics as well as a

Playstation 3, and Xbox 360. It is a rpg that combines core combat mechanics as well as a daily social school life system where both of them are intertwined to allow for smooth gameplay between both styles of gameplay. It is similar in gameplay to other games such as Persona 5 Royal and Persona 4 Golden that have also been Atlus titles.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Gameplay Mechanics

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Discuss the core gameplay mechanics and how they shape the player's experience.
- Explain how players control the game and interact with it.
- Identify and describe any unique aspects or creative elements in the game's gameplay.

Your Response:

You jump between a high school student's day to day life, making friends, doing jobs, and other things in the day time, however, during the nighttime you can jump into the game's labyrinth called Tartarus and fight the enemies known as Shadows to seek out a means to stop them from taking over the world. You can decide how you go about the day however you wish, leading to you choosing the pace for how fast your friendships grow and even decide to skip heading to Tartarus at night to do more activities during the night. The personas that you use to battle at night can help boost your friendships growth rate and conversely becoming best friends with someone allows you to create even stronger personas.



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Section #2: (1.25 pts.) Software Architecture And Technology

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Technical Framework

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game engine and any special software (middleware) used to make the game. Explain why these were important for making the game work.
- List the programming languages and software tools used to build the game. Discuss how these tools helped in creating the game's features.

Your Response:

The game uses unreal engine and it was used because Atlus had previously used unreal engine for their previous game Shin Megami Tensei V. They used it because they already had most of the Persona Models already created for SMTV and so it was far simpler to import them and then work things out from there. Unreal Engine primarily uses C++ and it helped the team because they had prior knowledge from their other completed products.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Innovations and Challenges

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Identify and describe any new or unique technical features in the game. Explain how these features made the game different or improved it.
- Discuss any major difficulties the developers encountered while making the game. Describe how they solved these problems.

Your Response:

The newest technical feature used in the game was Unreal Engine as it was the first time it was being used for the Persona Series, previously it was a different game engine. The main benefit was that they had access to all of Unreal Engine capabilities like native 4k resolution on consoles and PC and Ray Tracing. The biggest issue was the lack of resources but they overcame this by splitting up how they released content such as having the dlc come only after the base game was completed and cutting corners on other stuff.



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Section #3: (1.25 pts.) Gameplay Mechanics And Level Design

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Mechanics Analysis

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Explore and describe the main rules and actions that players use in the game.

- Explain how these core mechanics define the game's playstyle.
- Discuss how the game's core mechanics keep players interested and involved. Describe the ways these mechanics make the game fun or challenging.

Your Response:

The main rule is that the player can use their in game time however they wish meaning they can prioritize to get stronger with specific friends to make certain persona types even stronger allowing for one to diversify how they develop each of their personas role and character playstyle. The main way, it keeps the player involved is with a robust fusion system to be able to fuse together old personas in order to create new personas and combine attack skills from the two former ones to make the new one even stronger. It makes it more fun to be able to create your own builds for different ones that serve a new purpose with different passive and attacks to create your new favorite.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Level Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the design of the game's levels or environments. Focus on the layout, obstacles, and visual elements, and how they contribute to the game's setting.
- Explain how the level or environment design affects the way players play the game. Discuss how these design choices impact the overall experience, such as creating challenges, guiding the player, or setting the mood.

Your Response:

The game helps contribute to the setting by having the character dialogue and stories be about helping people to understand their purpose and what goal they should be aspiring for. The game's dshows this with the environments becoming more chaotic as the story goes on with many NPCs joining a cult and members of the cast holding on to their life and beliefs in order to create the world that they envision and not hold themselves to a cult's words. These impact the player by helping to settle the mood of the world especially when towards the end of tje game, each overworld theme ogets overriddebn witha new song to emphasize the state of the people living in there such as the streets being very hopeless and melachonly sounding while the student dorms have this hopeful and sad tune that encourages the player to fight to the very end.



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Section #4: (1.25 pts.) Graphic And Audio

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Graphic and Audio Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game's visual appearance and the artistic choices made. Discuss elements like color, art style, and thematic consistency, and how they contribute to the game's overall look and feel.
- Discuss the design of the game's characters and environments. Focus on aspects such as realism, creativity, and how they fit within the game's world. Explain how these designs enhance the player's immersion in the game.

Your Response:

The game uses a lot of blue based elements in its graphics for menus and such and it helps create a feeling of change as like it's water and how it will likely reach an familiar destination but how it gets there won't be known due to the changing of tides. The charcaters fit within the game world as each of them feel like they have reached a point in their life where they are stuck and they need someone to show and save them. It helps this sense of realism becasue not everyone's problems are on an equal scale and they might not all be good to begin with. In turn, it helps the player become more connected to the charcaters as they can understand the struggles that they have and want to help them overcome them, and as a result also help them in real life to understand and deal with their current predicament.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Audio Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Examine the game's sound design, focusing on the music and sound effects. Describe how they are used and their quality. Discuss any memorable or unique audio elements in the game.
- Explain how the game's audio contributes to its overall mood and setting. Discuss how sound and music influence the player's emotional response and enhance the gaming experience.

Your Response:

The game uses a lot of hip hop and rock for its sounds and they are used excellently with their vocals to help create the mood of the story with the lyrics told and the circumstances in which they play. Like how the main battle themes have primarily

lyrics going on with them and how the boss songs each only use small samples or no samples at all to make it clear how the player should take it seriously. Best examples is the final boss, which pulls the audio from a former safe area that the player had and turns it into a rock theme from its former aria appearance. The games audio contributes to the setting as it helps establish why you should care about the characters as they use purely instrumental songs to help drive sad points but in those songs they also have higher notes to represent hopefulness. It helps keep them hopefully even when the world feels like its going to end and in turn helps them to feel more motivated to continue.



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Section #5: (1.25 pts.) User Interface And User Experience

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - User Interface and User Experience

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the layout of the game's user interface (UI) and how it functions. Discuss elements like menus, icons, and on-screen prompts, and how they help players navigate and understand the game.
- Evaluate how well the game's UI communicates important information to players. Discuss aspects such as clarity, readability, and the ability of the UI to provide necessary game details without overwhelming or confusing the player.

Your Response:

The UI is primarily done through the pause menu and it functions where it is a more dynamic menu with moving background elements and a heavy focus on primary icons. The water themes helps drag the player's attention to certain key phrases and icons by having them near the top of the screen like they are resurfacing while still having a distinct moving background with its own minor elements to have this flair to them. The game helps communicate important information to the player through the in game tips as well as a place to check back on the tips shared. It also allows one to review any old tutorials from the menu as well as glossary to help figure out what key phrases or story elements actually are. The game puts all of that in the 'system' part of the main menu and all of these are at the top of the system section with big bold letters.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - UX Analysis

Details:

- Discuss the overall feel of playing the game, focusing on how different aspects of the game contribute to the player's experience. Analyze how these elements, such as ease of use, game flow, and feedback, affect the gameplay.
- Evaluate the design decisions made to enhance the player's experience. Consider factors like tutorial design, learning curve, and player engagement. Discuss how effective these choices are in making the game enjoyable and accessible to players.

Your Response:

When you play the game, the menus feel snappy and quick to move through and they help keep the pace of the game smooth and make it much easier to get used to after a certain amount of playtime where in the beginning it takes like 2 mins to equip something found from a chest to someone but then it becomes like 10 secs as you can either use the game's auto equip which only gives it to any current members in your main party who would gain a stat buff or by quickly opening the menu for a bit and equipping it to someone from your reserves using the up arrows near numbers to see where the boost occurs. They help make the game more accessible as they gradually will introduce mechanics as the player goes on and if the player forgets anything they have access to the system menu to be able to recall any information lost.



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Section #6: (1.25 pts.) Narrative And Storytelling

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Narrative Structure

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game's story, including its narrative structure, main plot points, and the setting in which it takes place. Discuss how these elements come together to create a cohesive and engaging story.
- Analyze the storytelling techniques used in the game, such as dialogue, cutscenes, or environmental storytelling. Evaluate how effectively these techniques convey the story and engage the player.

Your Response:

The game's story takes place in a remote part of Japan and has the protagonist move

there at the start of the game. They end up having to build an attachment to the people around them after essentially coming across all these people and not caring about them to then do anything for them. The game does this through its themes on life and death and tells the player to live life by having each piece of dialogue showing why people want to live and showing why you shouldn't wish to give in to death even when the world changes. This is especially shown near the end where most of the overworld npcs become despaired and wish for life to end but everyone central to the main protagonist continues to hold out and want to see their own life to the fullest. Its very effective because it helps keep the player in check with the story and keeps the story themes at the fore front.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Character and Integration

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Discuss the development of the game's characters. Describe their roles within the story, their personalities, and how they evolve throughout the game. Consider how the characters contribute to the overall narrative.
- Examine how the game's narrative and characters are integrated into the gameplay. Discuss how story elements are woven into the game mechanics and how this integration affects the player's experience.

Your Response:

The main cast start the game very apart where they basically only move to one goal which is stopping the shadows, but as time goes on each of them develop from basically co workers to becoming friends becoming their own dynamics and helping to each other wanting to find their answer for life. The best example of this getting intergrated into the gameplay is each party member's persona evolving. They only evolve after they overcome a tremendous hardship in the story and each of them fall upon another person's shoulders to help keep them stable and support them. These are integrated into the game mechanics because not only do the party members each get a cool new persona but they also learn an additional ultimate skill to help boost their combat performance. They help impact the player experience by helping to build further connection to the characters as well as giving them more skills to play around and build strategies with in combat.



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Section #7: (1.25 pts.) Impact And Reception

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Reception and Impact

Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Reception and Impact

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Research and summarize how the game was received by critics and players. Include key reviews, ratings, and player feedback. Discuss any notable praise or criticism the game received.
- Analyze the game's impact on the gaming industry. Discuss how it may have influenced game design, trends, or inspired other games. Consider any lasting effects it has had on the industry.

Your Response:

The game was recieved postively by both critics and players and it was noted to have an amazing story as well as rich character writing while still having core mechanics from the original Persona 3. The main praise was its story elements which is a constant factor in many of the reviews raved about the game as well as its rich ost. The game left a major impact on the gaming industry as it helped Atlus be willing to develop Persona 4 Revival in order to have a similar big impact to the game market.



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Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Cultural Significance

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Examine the game's cultural significance and the legacy it has left behind. Discuss how the game has been remembered over time and its status in the gaming community.
- Describe the game's presence and representation in media, such as films, books, or online content. Discuss its role in fan communities and any influence it has had on broader cultural aspects, such as art, music, or social trends.

Your Response:

The game has been remembered as a must play for any jrpg fan due to heavy approach non the themes of death. It is considered one of the core 3 games in the Persona Series and has constant merch acorss the world. Its role in music is far as it helped spread awareness of the singer Azumi Takahashi and helped pull classic fans of the original game by having Lotus Juice return as the rapper for the reimagined songs and the new ones.



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Section #8: (1.25 pts.) Reflection

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Describe your personal experience playing the chosen game

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Was it "fun"? What made it fun or not fun?
- Is this genre/game-type aligned with personal interests?
- What made you pick this game? Was it a good choice?

Your Response:

The game was fun due to the wide variety of personas and the different ways they could be used as well as the diverse story. The game aligned with my personal interests as I love the Persona Series and this was a game that I was always wanting to replay but now I can do it in a more modern form. I picked this game because I have done two playthroughs one of the original and one complete one of Reload with its dlc. It was a good choice because I have over 320 hours across Persona 3 content consumed across both versions and know the core points of the game by heart.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Assignment Reflection

Progress: 100%

Details:

- What interesting or new "thing(s)" did you learn during your research and analysis?
- Did you find it was easy to come across the information you were looking for? What was your primary means of research/analysis?

Your Response:

I learned that the dlc was only developed after the initial overview trailer and that it was not being developed side by side with the base game. It was easy to come across the information I was looking for as I have the original game information to go off of as well as my own personal experience with Persona 3 in general. In turn it made it really easy to recall any information from memory as well as any new information was readily accessible online.



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